

**Al Taha : V:81**

كُلُوا مِنْ طَيِّبَاتِ مَا رَزَقْنَاكُمْ وَلَا تَطْغَوْا فِيهِ فَيَحِلَّ عَلَيْكُمْ غَضَبِي ۖ وَمَنْ يَحِلَّ عَلَيْهِ غَضَبِي فَقَدْ هَوَىٰ ﴿٨١﴾ (طه:81)

**Explanation**

- In preceding verses Allah reminds of His tremendous favors upon the Children of Israel and His numerous blessings. He saved them from their enemy, Fir`awn, and He relieved their eyes by drowning him and his hosts all at one time while they watched.
- Then, they were commanded to enter a sacred city, but the Children of Israel refused and as punishment they were confined to a valley which is known as the valley of Tih (Sinai). They stayed there for forty years and in spite of the punishment which they were undergoing they continued to receive gifts from **Allah**, and the Mann and Salwa (a special kind of food) was one such gifts which was given to them for their sustenance.
- **Manna** was a sweet substance that descended upon them from the sky and the quail (**Salwa**) was a type of bird that would fall down to them. They would fill every pot with them as ample provisions until the following day. This was a kindness and a mercy from Allah upon them. It was a manifestation of Allah's good treatment of them. For this reason Allah says, “Eat of the **Tayyibat** wherewith We have provided you, and commit no transgression or oppression therein, lest My anger should justly descend on you”.
- This means, "Eat from this sustenance which I have provided for you, and do not transgress against My sustenance by taking it without necessity or you will be opposing what I have commanded you."
- “**Lest My anger should justly descend on you.**” This means, "I will become angry with you."
- “**And he on whom My anger descends, he is indeed perished.**” Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn Abbas said, "This means that he will indeed be made miserable." Concerning Allah's statement “**And verily, I am indeed forgiving to him who repents, believes and does righteous good deeds,**” meaning, "Whoever turns to Me in repentance, then I will accept his repentance regardless of whatever sin he did."
- مَا رَزَقْنَاكُمْ Is an expression of blessings. Provision or sustenance (rizq) has a linguistic sense of, “giving” or “apportionment” . However, it is used in different specific ways in the primary texts of the Qur’an and the Traditions (hadith) of the Holy Prophet (Allah bless him and give him peace). It sometimes refers to:

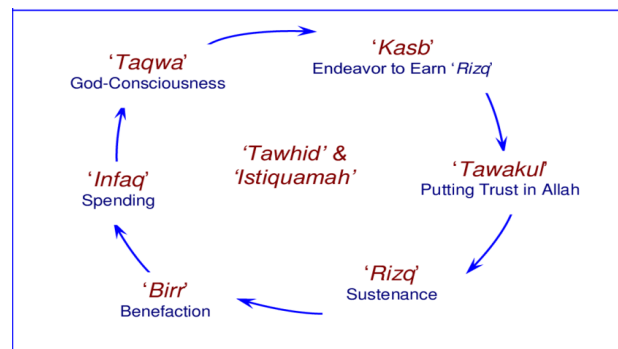
**(a)** the general worldly or next-worldly giving of blessings and the like. Allah Most High says, “[those] who believe in the unseen, keep up the prayer, and give out of what We have provided for them.” [2.3] i.e. that which we have given them and blessed them with;

(b) that which nourishes us— and by extension generally that which one wears or uses. The Messenger of Allah (Allah bless him and give him peace) said, “If you were to rely on Allah as He should be relied on, He would provide for you as He provides for the birds. They go out in the morning hungry and return in the evening full.” i.e. their bellies are full;

(c) a great good that has been granted to its possessor. Allah Most High says, “Give out of what We have provided for you, before death comes to one of you...” [63.10] i.e. from wealth, knowledge, and prestige. [Raghib, al-Mufradat fi Gharib al-Qur'an]

- **كُلُوا مِنْ طَيِّبَاتِ** **Tayyib** is a very comprehensive word and has a great place in the Qur'an and Sunnah. Tayyib is from taa-ya-ba and it literally means to be good, pleasant, agreeable, lawful. The word 'tayyib' itself means to be good, clean, wholesome, gentle, excellent, fair and lawful. From these meanings we get the general meaning for tayyib of anything that is good and pure. Tayyibaat in the Qur'an also refers to halaal (lawful) food. At-Tayyib is one of the Names of Allah ta'ala. At-Tayyib means the One far removed from every imperfection and deficiency. In Saheeh Muslim, Abu Hurayrah radi Allahu anhu reported that the Prophet sal Allahu alayhi wa sallam said “Allah is Good. He does not except but Good”. Indeed Allah is the Good, Far Removed from any Imperfection, and He only accepts that which is good. Allah ta'ala only accepts the good from the deeds and sayings.

#### The Concept of Rizq 1



(Verse 32-33 Al Araaf)

قُلْ مَنْ حَرَّمَ زِينَةَ اللَّهِ الَّتِي أَخْرَجَ لِعِبَادِهِ وَطَيِّبَاتِ مِنَ الرِّزْقِ قُلْ هِيَ لِلَّذِينَ آمَنُوا فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا خَالِصَةً يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ ۗ كَذَلِكَ نُفَصِّلُ الْآيَاتِ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٣٢﴾ قُلْ إِنَّمَا حَرَّمَ رِبِّيَ الْفَوَاحِشَ مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا وَمَا بَطَنَ وَالْإِثْمَ وَالْبَغْيَ بِغَيْرِ الْحَقِّ وَأَنْ تُشْرِكُوا بِاللَّهِ مَا لَمْ يُنَزَّلْ بِهِ سُلْطَانًا وَأَنْ تَقُولُوا عَلَى اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٣٣﴾ (الأعراف: 32-33)

#### Explanation

- Warned in the first verse are those who practice excess in acts of worship and introduce self-invented restrictions into it. They would abstain from things made Halal by Allah Ta'ala and go on to make them Haram on them and call it an act of obedience to and worship of Allah - as was the case of the disbelievers of Makkah who just did not consider wearing clothes in Tawaf during the days of Hajj as permissible and who used to think of abstinence from good food made lawful by Allah Ta'ali to be an act of worship.
- مَنْ حَرَّمَ Such people have been sternly reprimanded in a chastising mode by inquiring as to who has made good and becoming dress created by Allah for his servants and the good and pure foods bestowed by Him Haram for people?
- It means that to determine and declare something to be Halal or Haram is the sole right of the Most Sacred Being that has created it.
- The Holy Prophet (SAWW) has said: When Allah Ta'ala blesses a servant of His with extended means, He likes to see the effect of His blessing on things around him. However, it is necessary to guard against two things, that is, from hypocrisy and exhibitionism, and from pride and arrogance.
- The next sentence of the verse **قُلْ هِيَ لِلَّذِينَ آمَنُوا فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا خَالِصَةً يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ** explains the wisdom behind it. It says that all blessings, which include fine dresses and nice foods, have really been created for obedient believers. Others are enjoying these because of them - because this world is the venue of deeds not the venue of rewards. You cannot draw a line of distinction between the genuine and the counterfeit, the good and the bad in the matter of blessings available in this mortal world.
- At the end of the verse, it was said: **كَذَلِكَ نُفَصِّلُ الْآيَاتِ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ** (This is how We elaborate the verses for people who understand). This verse carries a refutation of the excessive deeds and ignorant views of people who suggested that Allah Ta'ala is pleased with the practice of abandoning good dress and good food.
- After that, the second verse takes up the description of some of the things declared unlawful by Allah Ta'ala forsaking which really brings His pleasure. The hint given here is that these people were suffering from a twofold ignorance. On the one hand, they deprived themselves of the good things of life Allah had made lawful for them by denying to use them as if they were unlawful - and did so for no reason. Then, on the other hand, there were things genuinely and really unlawful, things the use of which was to result in the wrath of Allah and the punishment of the Hereafter.

- In the detail given above, the word: (*ithm* : sin) covers all sins which fall on one personally - and in: (*baghy* : injustice) included there are sins which relate to rights and dealings as concerning others. Then is Shirk, the associating of partners with Allah, and the forging of lies against Him.
- This particular detail was mentioned here also because it covers almost all kinds of prohibitions and sins - whether they pertained to belief or conduct, or were done personally, or related to rights of others which were usurped.
- Therefore, the harm caused by excess in religion and innovation in established faith is twofold. First of all getting involved with such *Ghuluww* and *Bid'ah* is a sin in itself. Then, seen in contrast, far too grave is the very deprivation from the true religion of Allah and the genuine way of the Holy Prophet (SAWW). Refuge with Allah (from such a fate).

وَلَا تَأْكُلُوا أَمْوَالَكُمْ بَيْنَكُمْ بِالْبَاطِلِ وَتُدْخِلُوا بِهَا إِلَى الْحُكَّامِ لِتَأْكُلُوا فَرِيقًا مِنْ أَمْوَالِ النَّاسِ بِالْإِثْمِ وَأَنْتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ ﴿١٨٨﴾ (البقرة: 188)

### Context:

This verse was revealed in the background of a particular event which relates to a land dispute between two of the noble Companions. The case came up for hearing in the court of the Holy Prophet (SAWW). The plaintiff had no witnesses. The Holy Prophet (SAWW) asked the defendant to take an oath in accordance with Islamic legal norm. He was all set to take the oath when the Holy Prophet (SAWW) recited the following verse before him as a matter of good counsel: “Surely, those who take a small price out of the covenant of Allah and out of their oaths, for them there is no share in the Hereafter. (3:77)”

When the Companion heard this verse which warns those who try to take over someone's property through a false oath, he abandoned his intention to take that oath and surrendered the land to the plaintiff. (Ruh al-Ma'ani)

### Explanation

- Previous verses dealt with injunctions relating to fasting, in this verse, the acquisition and use of *haram* or unlawful wealth or property has been forbidden.
- This verse forbids the acquisition and use of wealth and property by unlawful means.
- The Law of the permissible and the forbidden enforced by the shari'ah of Islam comes clearly through divine revelation, or is derived from it.
- The present verse covers all such impermissible situations and aspects.
- This was the background under which this verse was revealed. To begin with, it forbids the acquiring of someone's property by unlawful means, **then towards the later part, it**

**warns against the filing of false cases, taking of false oaths and the giving or commissioning of false witnesses.**

- The words of this divine injunction are general: 'And do not eat up each other's property by false means'. This includes the usurping of someone's property, and theft, and robbery, through which money or property belonging to someone is taken away by force. Then, there is interest, gambling, bribery and all defective sales and transactions which are also impermissible under the dictates of the Islamic law, even though, there be the certitude of consent given by concerned parties. Again, any money or property acquired through lying or a false oath, or earnings which have been prohibited by Islamic law, even though one has personally sweated out to earn it, are all *haram*, unlawful and false. Though the words of the Qur'an forbid 'eating' quite clearly, but the drive of the meaning here is not restricted to 'eating' as such, instead, it means 'using' in the absolute sense; it could be by eating, drinking, wearing or by any other mode of use.
- **وَتَذْلُوا بِهَا إِلَى الْحُكَّامِ لِتَأْكُلُوا فَرِيقًا مِّنْ أَمْوَالِ النَّاسِ** means: 'Do not take property cases to the authorities, so that through them, you eat up some portion of the property of the people sinfully while you do know that you have no right therein and you are simply putting up a false case.
- The word **وَأَنْتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ** (while you know) at the end of the verse tell us that a person, who claims something on the basis of misunderstanding and files a suit in the court to acquire it, will not be covered by this warning.

### **Significance of Lawful Earning**

- **Halal brings blessings ; Haraam produces evil:** There are several places in the Holy Qur'an where the abstention from the unlawful and the acquisition of the lawful has been stressed upon in many different ways. It has also been pointed out in a verse that human deeds and morals are enormously affected by eating what is lawful. If one does not eat and drink <sup>halal</sup> things, it is almost impossible to expect good moral and righteous deeds coming from that person. It was said in the Holy Qur'an: *O messengers eat of the good things and be righteous in deeds. I am aware of what you do. (23:51)*
- In this verse, it will be noted that eating of the lawful has been combined with the command to do what is righteous. The hint is that righteous deeds can issue forth only when man eats and drinks what is lawful. The Holy Prophet & has himself made it clear in a hadith that the address in this verse is, no doubt, to prophets, but this command is not restricted to them alone, instead, all Muslims are charged with it. Towards the end of this hadith, he also said that the prayer of a person who eats what is unlawful is not answered. The Holy Prophet adds that there are many people who take great pains in their acts of

worship, then raise their hands in prayer before Allah Almighty and say, 'O Lord, O Lord' but what they eat is haram, what they drink is haram, what they wear is haram, if so, how can this prayer of theirs be answered?

- **He said:** 'One who ate *halal*, followed the *sunnah* and people were not hurt by him, he will go to Paradise.' The blessed Companions said, 'O Messenger of Allah, right now these things are common in your community. Most Muslims observe these strictly.' He said: 'Yes! In future too, in every age, there will be people who shall abide by these rules.' **(This hadith has been reported by t i r m i d h i and he calls it sahih)**
- **In another hadith, the Holy Prophet (SAWW) is reported** to have said to the blessed Companion 'Abdullah ibn 'Umar: There are four traits, if these are in you and you have nothing else in the world, they shall suffice you. Those four traits are: Guarding a trust, telling the truth, good morals and being particular in eating what is *halal*."
- **The blessed Companion Sa'd ibn Waqqas (R.A)** requested the Holy Prophet (SAWW) & to pray for him so that he may become one of those whose prayers are accepted. He said: O Sa'd, make what you eat permissible and pure, and you shall become one whose prayers are responded to. And by Him in whose hands rests the life of Muhammad, when the servant of Allah slips a morsel of what is *haram* into his stomach, no deed of his is accepted for the next forty days. And a person whose flesh is made of unlawful acquisitions, for that flesh the fire of Hell is the only recipient.
- **The blessed Companion 'Abdullah ibn Masood (R.A.) reports** that the Holy Prophet (SAWW) & said: By him in whose hands rests my life, no servant of Allah becomes a Muslim unless his heart and tongue become Muslim and until his neighbors become secure from his distressing deeds. And when a servant acquires the unlawful and then gives it in charity, that is not accepted; and if he spends out of it, it stays deprived of blessings; and if he leaves it behind for his inheritors, it becomes his wherewithal for the trip to Hell. Surely, Allah Almighty does not help an evil wash off another evil, but He does help the washing away of an evil deed with a good deed.
- **The blessed Companion Mu'adh ibn Jabal (R.A) reports** that the Holy Prophet (SAWW) said: No servant of Allah shall move a step on Doomsday unless he is made to answer four questions; firstly, about his life, in what did he spend it out; secondly, about his youth, in what did he consume it; thirdly, about his wealth, where from did he earn it and in what did he spend it; and fourthly, about his knowledge, how far did he act in line with it.' (Al-Bayhaqi, Targhib)

- The blessed Companion, 'Abdullah ibn 'Umar (R.A.) reports that the Holy Prophet (SAWW) once gave a sermon in which he said: *O Emigrants, I seek the refuge of Allah Almighty against five traits of character* lest they should grow into you: **firstly**, against immodesty, for when immodesty prevails in a people they are hit by plagues, epidemics and ever-new diseases not even heard of by their elders; and **secondly**, against cheating in weights and measures, for when this disease grips a people, they are hit by famine, price-hikes, rigorous labour and over-work and oppressive rulers; and **thirdly**, against non-payment of Zakah, for when people do not pay zakah, rains are stopped; and **fourthly**, against the religious apathy of people, for when a community breaks its covenant with Allah and His Messenger, then Allah Almighty makes alien enemies sit over them who snatch away what belongs to them without any justification; and **fifthly**, against the apathy of ruling authority, for when the rulers of a people fail to decide matters in accordance with the Book of Allah because the injunctions revealed by Allah Almighty do not suit their fancies, then Allah Almighty causes mutual hatred and disputations descend upon them. (This narration has been reported by Ibn Majah, al-Bayhaqi, and others and al-Hakim has called it **sahih** according to the standard set by Muslim.)
- Receiving the Protection of God
- Acceptance of Prayer
- Receiving God's Glory and Honor on the Day of Judgment
- Strengthening One's Faith
- Getting Allah's Blessings and Favors (*Barakah*)
- Lawful earnings and sound wealth, safe guards the religion, protects one's honor, beautifies one's face, and results in a strong position.
- Halal establishes sustainable economic growth and development at individual and collective level
- It controls inflation, economic unrest, recessions